even the small moments it did briefly, it always returned stronger and brighter than it had ever been. I felt that even this time yesterday, bowling to the West Indies, chasing that inconsequential ball to the boundary as if my life depended on it. As the memories vanish back into the emptiness, I ask something of myself. It is like the cricketer I have been, the one I've just watched flash through his career, is speaking to the person I am becoming now. Always look for the hope that comes from the daily act of showing up. That is where the genius has always been. Remember that.

It strikes me as I look out on to the pitch, contemplating whether I miss it that much already, that my life now will be this exact view: the outside looking in. This is how I will experience cricket now – from this vantage point. It's like I'm looking at it for the first time. Just as I have learned again and again, cricket is good at renewal, at gifting transformation. I don't know what the future will be. It could all be brand new.